OF THE LAWS OF ECCLESIASTICAL POLITY

Book IV: In Defense of Reformed Catholic Worship

by Richard Hooker (1554-1600)

A Study Guide with Contemporary Translations and Commentary

Via Media

Introduction to Book IV

Having established the theoretical foundations in Books I-III, Hooker now applies his principles to **specific Puritan objections** against Anglican worship practices.

THE PURITAN PRINCIPLE:

"If it looks Roman Catholic, it's wrong!"

The Puritans operated on what Hooker called a **negative principle**:

1. Rome is corrupt and superstitious
2. Rome uses ceremonies, vestments, and liturgies
3. Therefore, anything Rome does must be abolished
4. We must do the opposite of Rome in all things

Examples of Puritan Objections:

They rejected:

- Kneeling at communion (Rome does this!)
- Wearing vestments (Rome does this!)
- Set prayers/liturgy (Rome does this!)
- Making the sign of the cross (Rome does this!)
- Church festivals (Christmas, Easter - Rome does this!)
- Organ music (Rome does this!)

- Clerical clothing (Rome does this!)

HOOKER'S COUNTER-ARGUMENT:

This is **guilt by association** - a logical fallacy. Just because Rome uses something doesn't make it wrong.

Hooker's Positive Principle:

1. Does it serve edification?
2. Does it contradict Scripture?
3. Does it aid devotion?
4. Does it promote order and reverence?

If YES to 1, 3, 4 and NO to 2 → It's legitimate, regardless of Rome's use.

AT STAKE:

- How should Protestants worship?
- Can tradition guide worship practices?
- What makes something "too Catholic"?
- Is simplicity always better than ceremony?

BOOK IV, SECTION 1

The Puritan "Guilt by Association" Fallacy

Oppose abuse, not legitimate use

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

Not things which are universally belonging to the Church of God, they oppose in the Church of Rome, but things wherein the Church of Rome doth universally abuse the Church of God.

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

The problem isn't with practices that belong universally to God's church—it's with how the Church of Rome has abused these practices.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker's crucial distinction: **Abuse doesn't negate right use.**

THE LOGIC EXPOSED:

Puritan reasoning:

1. Rome abuses X
2. Therefore X is bad
3. Therefore we must abandon X

Hooker's correction:

1. Rome abuses X
2. X can be used rightly
3. Therefore we should use X rightly, not abandon it

EXAMPLES:

SCRIPTURE:

- Rome claimed exclusive interpretation rights (abuse)
- Puritans said: "We must reject tradition and church authority completely"
- Hooker: "No—use Scripture rightly, with reason and tradition as aids"

SACRAMENTS:

- Rome taught transubstantiation and Mass as sacrifice (abuse)
- Puritans said: "Minimize ceremony around sacraments"
- Hooker: "No—celebrate sacraments richly, but with right doctrine"

CHURCH MUSIC:

- Rome had elaborate choirs and Latin chants (some excess)
- Puritans said: "Only unaccompanied psalm singing"

- Hooker: "No—use music to glorify God, just not superstitiously"

VESTMENTS:

- Rome had many elaborate vestments with superstitious meanings
- Puritans said: "Plain clothes only"
- Hooker: "No—simple vestments promote reverence and order"

THE PRINCIPLE:

Don't throw out the baby with the bathwater.

Just because Rome corrupted something doesn't mean the thing itself is corrupt.

Modern Parallel:

"Cults use the Bible, therefore we shouldn't use the Bible" - Obviously absurd!

Similarly: "Rome uses ceremonies, therefore we shouldn't use ceremonies" - Equally absurd!

§2 - What Makes Something "Popish"?

Fear of label, not reasoned judgment

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

The name of Popery doth so trouble them, that their only care is to avoid it, as the Jews did to shun the touch of the unclean thing; they never examine, they never consider the cause why that should be shunned.

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

The label "Popish" troubles them so much that their only concern is avoiding it—like Jews avoiding unclean things. They never examine or consider the actual reason something should be avoided.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker exposes **irrational fear** replacing **reasoned evaluation**.

THE PURITAN ERROR:

They made "Popish" a label that ended all discussion:

- "That's Popish!" = Argument over, case closed
- No need to examine whether the practice itself is good
- No need to ask if Scripture forbids it
- Just: "Rome does it, so we don't"

HOOKER'S QUESTIONS:

Before calling something "Popish," ask:

1. **Is it contrary to Scripture?**
    - If NO, it's not wrong just because Rome uses it
2. **Does Rome use it superstitiously?**
    - Then correct the superstition, don't abandon the practice
3. **Does it serve edification?**
    - If YES, use it rightly regardless of Rome
4. **Is the objection based on reason or emotion?**
    - Fear of labels isn't a theological argument

EXAMPLES OF PURITAN OVERREACTION:

KNEELING:

- **Puritan:** "Popish! Rome kneels before the host!"
- **Hooker:** "Kneeling shows reverence. Do it rightly, not superstitiously."

SET PRAYERS:

- **Puritan:** "Popish! Rome has written prayers!"
- **Hooker:** "So did Old Testament worship. Jesus gave us the Lord's Prayer."

CHURCH BUILDINGS:

- **Puritan:** "Popish! Rome has ornate churches!"
- **Hooker:** "So did Israel with the temple. Beauty honors God."

CHRISTMAS:

- **Puritan:** "Popish! Rome celebrates Christmas!"
- **Hooker:** "Commemorating Christ's birth isn't wrong because Rome does it."

THE PRINCIPLE:

Evaluate practices by their merit, not by association.

Ask: "Is this biblical? Does it edify? Does it honor God?" Not: "Does Rome do this?"

God uses visible symbols

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

We are to note that God in delivering his Law did not only teach what should be done, but added also outward sensible observations, that man might by a kind of visible rhetoric be instructed in the mystery of divine knowledge.

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

We should note that when God gave his law, he didn't only teach what should be done—he also added outward, sensible observances, so that humanity might be instructed in divine truth through a kind of visible rhetoric.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker's profound insight: **God himself uses ceremony to teach.**

BIBLICAL EVIDENCE:

Old Testament:

- **Circumcision** - Physical sign of covenant
- **Passover** - Elaborate ceremony teaching salvation
- **Tabernacle/Temple** - Rich symbolism and beauty
- **Priestly vestments** - Visual teaching of holiness
- **Festivals** - Commemorating God's acts
- **Sacrifices** - Physical enactment of atonement

New Testament:

- **Baptism** - Physical sign of spiritual reality
- **Lord's Supper** - Visible proclamation of Christ's death
- **Laying on of hands** - Physical act of commissioning
- **Anointing with oil** - Tangible prayer for healing

THE PRINCIPLE:

God accommodates himself to human nature.

Humans are:

- **Physical** beings (not just minds/souls)
- **Visual** learners (we learn through sight)
- **Emotional** creatures (moved by beauty and reverence)
- **Social** beings (ceremonies unite us)

Therefore God uses **physical ceremonies** to teach **spiritual truths**.

HOOKER'S ARGUMENT:

1. **God instituted ceremonies** in both testaments

2. **Christ didn't abolish ceremonial worship**, just specific OT ceremonies
3. **The church has always used ceremonies** (even in apostolic times)
4. **Ceremonies serve important purposes**

PURPOSES OF CEREMONIES:

1. TEACHING:

- Make abstract truths concrete
- Help us remember important doctrines
- Reinforce through repetition

2. REVERENCE:

- Create appropriate solemnity
- Distinguish sacred from common
- Promote proper attitude

3. BEAUTY:

- Honor God with our best
- Reflect God's glory
- Engage aesthetic sense

4. UNITY:

- Common practices bind us together
- Corporate expression of faith
- Visible church identity

5. ORDER:

- Prevent confusion and chaos
- Provide structure for worship
- Ensure decency

§4 - The Old Testament Ceremonial Law and Christian Worship

Law's purpose:
access to God

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

The end of the Law is not to make a separation between us and God, but to give us an open passage towards him.

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

The law's purpose isn't to separate us from God, but to give us open access to him.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker makes **crucial distinctions** about the ceremonial law:

THREE ASPECTS OF OLD TESTAMENT CEREMONIAL LAW:

1. SYMBOLIC/TYPICAL ASPECTS (Abolished)

What: Sacrifices, priesthood, temple rituals that pointed to Christ

Why abolished: Fulfilled in Christ

Examples:

- Animal sacrifices → Christ's once-for-all sacrifice
- Levitical priesthood → Christ our high priest
- Temple → Christ's body, church as temple

Hebrews 10:1 - "The law is only a shadow of the good things that are coming"

2. MORAL ASPECTS (Permanent)

What: Principles of holiness, reverence, approach to God

Why permanent: Based on God's unchanging character

Examples:

- God is holy → We must approach with reverence
- Worship requires preparation → We should prepare our hearts
- Sacred/common distinction → God deserves special honor

These principles abide, though specific forms change.

3. PEDAGOGICAL ASPECTS (Adaptable)

What: Teaching methods using physical symbols

Why adaptable: Principle remains, application changes

Examples:

- **OT:** Incense = prayers rising to God
- **Principle:** Worship should engage multiple senses
- **NT application:** Beautiful music, reverent gestures, visual symbols

HOOKER'S PRINCIPLE:

The ceremonial law teaches us:

1. **God values beauty in worship** (temple splendor)
2. **God uses physical symbols** (all the rituals)
3. **God requires reverence** (strict procedures)
4. **God desires order** (detailed instructions)

These principles **continue**, though specific forms (animal sacrifice, etc.) are **fulfilled in Christ**.

THE PURITAN ERROR:

They threw out both the fulfilled forms AND the abiding principles.

Result:

- No beauty (God commanded it in OT)
- No ceremony (God instituted it in OT)
- No reverence aids (God used them in OT)
- Bare, plain worship (unlike God's commands in OT)

HOOKER'S WISDOM:

Learn from the OT what God values:

- ✓ Beauty and excellence
- ✓ Order and structure
- ✓ Reverence and solemnity
- ✓ Physical engagement in worship

But don't replicate specific fulfilled forms:

- ✗ Animal sacrifice
- ✗ Levitical priesthood
- ✗ Physical temple in Jerusalem

§5 - Defending Specific Practices: Kneeling at Communion

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

Where we kneel, we offer unto Christ himself that adoration which is proper to Christ, not in that he is bread, but that he is God.

Kneel to Christ, not to bread

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

When we kneel, we offer Christ the adoration proper to him—not because he's the bread, but because he's God.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker's brilliant distinction: **Same act, different meaning.**

THE ISSUE:

- **Rome says:** Kneel because the bread IS literally Christ's body (transubstantiation)
- **Puritans say:** Don't kneel because that implies transubstantiation
- **Hooker says:** Kneel because Christ is spiritually present in the sacrament, worthy of adoration

THE PRINCIPLE:

The same physical action can have different meanings based on intention and understanding.

Examples:

Bowing:

- Before a king → Respect for authority (legitimate)
- Before an idol → Worship of false god (idolatry)
- **Same action, different meaning!**

Kneeling:

- Before Christ in prayer → Reverence and submission (right)
- Before bread thinking it IS Christ → Idolatry (wrong)
- Before Christ during communion → Reverence for spiritual presence (right)

BIBLICAL BASIS FOR KNEELING:

Old Testament:

- Solomon knelt at temple dedication (1 Kings 8:54)
- David knelt in worship (Psalm 95:6)
- Daniel knelt in prayer (Daniel 6:10)

New Testament:

- Jesus knelt in prayer (Luke 22:41)
- Peter knelt in prayer (Acts 9:40)
- Paul knelt with elders (Acts 20:36)

- Every knee shall bow to Christ (Phil 2:10)

HOOKER'S QUESTIONS:

To Puritans:

1. Is kneeling in worship biblical? YES
2. Is Christ present (spiritually) in communion? YES
3. Is Christ worthy of adoration? YES
4. Then why not kneel at communion?

Puritan answer: "Because Rome does it!"

Hooker: That's not a theological argument!

THE PRINCIPLE:

- **Right practice + wrong doctrine = abuse**
- **Right practice + right doctrine = edification**

Don't abandon right practices because others abuse them. Correct the doctrine!

§6 - Defending Vestments and Clerical Dress

Visible distinction aids order

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

For distinction of persons by their attire, is expedient for the better ordering of the Church of God.

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

Distinguishing people by their attire is beneficial for better ordering God's church.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker defends **appropriate symbolism** in dress.

BIBLICAL PRECEDENT:

Old Testament:

- Priests had specific garments (Exodus 28)
- High priest had distinctive dress (Exodus 39)
- These symbolized holiness and office
- God himself commanded them!

New Testament:

- All believers are priests (1 Peter 2:9) - TRUE
- But there are still offices (pastor, elder, deacon) - ALSO TRUE

HOOKER'S ARGUMENT:

1. VISUAL DISTINCTION SERVES ORDER:

In any organized society, roles have visual markers:

- Judges wear robes → Shows their office
- Police wear uniforms → Shows their authority
- Doctors wear white coats → Shows their profession

Why? Because **visual cues help order and understanding**.

Similarly in church:

- Ministers wear vestments → Shows their office
- Helps congregation recognize leaders
- Creates appropriate dignity for the office

2. VESTMENTS DON'T CREATE SUPERIORITY:

Puritan fear: Vestments make clergy think they're better than laity

Hooker's response:

- A judge's robe doesn't make him morally superior
- A doctor's coat doesn't make him holier

- A minister's vestment doesn't make him spiritually superior

It just marks the **office**, not the **person**.

3. SIMPLICITY ISN'T THE ONLY VIRTUE:

Puritans valued: Simplicity above all

Hooker noted: God also values:

- Beauty (OT temple)
- Order (detailed regulations)
- Dignity (reverent worship)
- Excellence (best offered to God)

4. PRACTICAL BENEFITS:

Vestments:

- Create unity (all ministers dressed similarly)
- Show respect for worship
- Help minister focus on God (not on fashion)
- Distinguish sacred time from ordinary time

HOOKER'S PRINCIPLE:

It's not about the clothes, it's about what they serve:

- ✓ Do they promote order? YES
- ✓ Do they aid reverence? YES
- ✓ Do they contradict Scripture? NO

- ✓ Do they claim spiritual superiority? NO

Then they're permissible and beneficial.

Modern Application:

Why do churches today have:

- Graduation robes? (Marks accomplishment)
- Wedding attire? (Marks significance)
- Choir robes? (Creates unity)

Same principle: Appropriate dress for significant occasions serves order and dignity.

Preparation ≠ insincerity

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

They which do good things, they do them not the worse, because they think before what they do.

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

People who do good things don't do them worse because they've thought beforehand about what they'll do.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker defends **prepared prayer** as equally sincere.

THE FALSE DICHOTOMY:

Puritans claimed ONLY TWO OPTIONS:

1. Spontaneous prayer = from the heart = sincere
2. Written prayer = dead = insincere

Hooker shows BOTH can be sincere OR insincere:

SPONTANEOUS PRAYER:

- ✓ Can be heartfelt and sincere
- ✗ Can also be rambling and thoughtless
- ✗ Can become repetitive (same phrases every time)
- ✗ Can be unprepared and shallow

SET PRAYER:

- ✓ Can be heartfelt and sincere
- ✓ Can be beautifully crafted and deep
- ✓ Can teach theology through repetition
- ✗ Can become mere recitation without thought

BIBLICAL EVIDENCE FOR SET PRAYERS:

Old Testament:

- Psalms (written prayers for corporate worship)
- Temple liturgies (fixed forms)
- Jewish daily prayers (Shema, etc.)

New Testament:

- Lord's Prayer (Jesus gave fixed form!)
- Early Christian hymns (Col 1:15-20, Phil 2:6-11)
- Benedictions (2 Cor 13:14, Num 6:24-26)

If Jesus gave us a written prayer (Lord's Prayer), how can written prayers be wrong?

HOOKER'S ARGUMENTS FOR SET PRAYERS:

1. THEOLOGICAL RICHNESS:

Written prayers can be:

- Carefully crafted for beauty
- Theologically deep and accurate
- Drawing on Scripture throughout
- Covering all aspects of faith

Spontaneous prayer often:

- Repeats same simple phrases
- Misses important doctrines
- Reflects individual's limited knowledge

2. CORPORATE UNITY:

Set prayers allow:

- Whole congregation praying together
- Unity in words and thought
- Powerful corporate witness

Spontaneous prayer:

- Only minister prays (congregation passive)
- No opportunity for unified response

3. TEACHING FUNCTION:

Fixed prayers:

- Teach theology through repetition
- Form habits of prayer
- Provide models for private prayer

4. PREPARATION SHOWS RESPECT:

- Do we improvise wedding vows? Often no—we prepare!
- Do we improvise important speeches? No—we prepare!
- Why should addressing God be less prepared?

HOOKER'S BALANCE:

Best approach: BOTH spontaneous AND set prayers

In worship:

- Use set prayers for corporate unity
- Include spontaneous prayers for particular needs
- Alternate between forms

In private:

- Use set prayers as framework
- Add spontaneous prayers as led
- Draw on both Scripture and Spirit

THE PRINCIPLE:

What matters is the HEART, not the FORMAT.

Both spontaneous and set prayers can be:

- Sincere or insincere
- Deep or shallow
- Spirit-filled or dead

Judge by fruit, not form!

§8 - Church Festivals and Holy Days

Commemorating God's acts honors Him

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

The sanctification of days is a token of thankfulness, and a part of God's public honor.

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

Setting apart special days is a sign of thanksgiving and part of God's public honor.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker defends **commemorative celebrations** as biblical and edifying.

BIBLICAL FOUNDATION:

Old Testament:

God **commanded** special days:

- **Sabbath** - Weekly rest and worship
- **Passover** - Commemorate exodus from Egypt
- **Feast of Tabernacles** - Remember wilderness wandering
- **Purim** - Celebrate deliverance through Esther
- **Dedication** - Celebrate temple rededication (Hanukkah)

New Testament:

Jesus observed:

- Passover (Last Supper)
- Dedication/Hanukkah (John 10:22)
- Sabbath (regularly in synagogue)

THE PRINCIPLE:

Commemorating God's mighty acts through special days:

1. Honors God
2. Teaches the faith
3. Builds community
4. Creates rhythm in life

HOOKER'S ARGUMENTS:

1. NOT COMMANDED ≠ FORBIDDEN:

Puritan error: "Scripture doesn't command Christmas, therefore it's wrong"

Hooker: Scripture doesn't forbid commemorating Christ's birth! By Puritan logic:

- Mother's Day = wrong (not in Scripture)
- National holidays = wrong (not in Scripture)
- Birthday celebrations = wrong (not in Scripture)

2. COMMEMORATING CHRIST IS GOOD:

If commemorating Old Testament events was commanded (Passover, etc.), how can commemorating **Christ's birth, death, resurrection** be wrong?

3. FESTIVALS TEACH THE FAITH:

Christmas:

- Incarnation (God became flesh)
- Humility (born in manger)
- God's plan from eternity

Easter:

- Christ's death (atonement)
- Resurrection (victory over death)
- Hope of our resurrection

Pentecost:

- Spirit poured out

- Birth of church
- Power for mission

These truths need regular teaching!

4. NO SUPERSTITION REQUIRED:

Puritan fear: Festivals lead to superstition

Hooker: Only if taught wrongly! Teach:

- ✓ Days commemorate, not create holiness
- ✓ Observance is beneficial, not mandatory
- ✓ Focus on events, not magical dates

5. PASTORAL WISDOM:

Most people:

- Need rhythms and structure
- Benefit from annual reminders
- Are strengthened by corporate celebration

Festivals provide:

- Natural teaching opportunities
- Community gathering times
- Joyful celebration of faith

MODERN APPLICATION:

Why celebrate:

- Christmas → Remember incarnation
- Easter → Celebrate resurrection
- Pentecost → Honor Spirit's work

How to celebrate rightly:

- Focus on biblical truth
- Avoid superstition
- Don't make them mandatory
- Use as teaching opportunities

§9 - The "Weaker Brother" Argument

Remove abuse, not use

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

If any offend the weak by abusing that which is lawful, we ought to take away the abuse, but not the use itself.

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

If anyone offends the weak by misusing what's lawful, we should eliminate the misuse, but not the lawful practice itself.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker carefully applies **Paul's teaching** on weak brothers (Romans 14-15, 1 Corinthians 8-10).

PAUL'S ACTUAL TEACHING:

On Food Sacrificed to Idols (1 Cor 8-10):

- **Strong Christians:** "Idols are nothing, so food sacrificed to them is just food"
- **Weak Christians:** "Eating idol-food might lead me back to idolatry"

Paul's solution:

- The strong are RIGHT (idols are nothing)
- BUT love requires not flaunting freedom
- Don't eat if it causes a brother to stumble into actual sin
- However, don't let weak consciences control everything

HOOKER'S APPLICATION:

Three Key Points:

1. WHO IS THE "WEAK BROTHER"?

- **NOT:** Someone who merely disagrees
- **NOT:** Someone who objects on principle
- **YES:** Someone whose conscience would be genuinely violated
- **YES:** Someone who might sin by following your example

Puritans weren't "weak brothers" - they were strong opponents claiming ceremonies were **wrong**, not just problematic for weak consciences.

2. LOVE REQUIRES REMOVING STUMBLING BLOCKS, NOT ALL DIFFERENCES:

Paul's principle:

- Don't cause someone to **sin**
- Don't lead someone to violate their **conscience**

Paul did NOT say:

- Eliminate everything someone objects to
- Let objectors control all church practice
- Never do anything that bothers anyone

3. HOOKER'S DISTINCTION:

Remove the ABUSE (if any):

- ✓ Teach ceremonies don't earn salvation
- ✓ Explain they're aids, not requirements
- ✓ Make clear they're not magical

Keep the RIGHT USE:

- ✓ Ceremonies still edify
- ✓ They serve biblical purposes
- ✓ They help many worship better

THE CRUCIAL QUESTION:

Are Puritans genuinely weak brothers whose consciences would be violated?

OR

Are they strong opponents who simply disagree and want to control church practice?

Hooker's verdict: The latter. They're not weak—they're demanding conformity to their views.

PAUL'S OWN PRACTICE:

Paul accommodated weak consciences:

- Circumcised Timothy (Acts 16:3) - for witness to Jews
- Kept vows (Acts 21:23-26) - to avoid offense

But Paul also RESISTED those who demanded conformity:

- Refused to circumcise Titus (Gal 2:3) - when it became a requirement
- Opposed Peter's hypocrisy (Gal 2:11-14) - when it compromised gospel freedom

HOOKER'S PRINCIPLE:

- **Accommodate genuine weakness → YES**
- **Surrender to demanding opponents → NO**

The difference:

- Weak brothers need patience and teaching
- Demanding opponents need to be resisted for the sake of freedom

§10 - Conclusion: A Positive Vision for Worship

ORIGINAL TEXT (1593)

Our end ought to be, in these things, public edification, whereunto nothing is more profitably conducible than the uniform orders set down by authority.

Order serves edification

CONTEMPORARY TRANSLATION

Our goal in these matters should be public edification, and nothing contributes more profitably to this than uniform practices established by legitimate authority.

COMMENTARY:

Hooker's **positive vision** vs. Puritan **negative reaction**:

THE PURITAN APPROACH (Negative):

Define worship by what to AVOID:

- ✗ Don't do what Rome does

- ✗ Don't use ceremonies
- ✗ Don't have beauty
- ✗ Don't offend Puritans
- ✗ Don't trust tradition
- ✗ Don't use written prayers

Result: Bare, stark, reactive worship

HOOKER'S APPROACH (Positive):

Define worship by what SERVES EDIFICATION:

- ✓ Does it teach truth?
- ✓ Does it promote reverence?
- ✓ Does it create beauty?
- ✓ Does it build unity?
- ✓ Does it aid devotion?
- ✓ Does it honor God?

Result: Rich, full, purposeful worship

THE CRITERIA FOR GOOD WORSHIP PRACTICES:

1. BIBLICAL:

- Not contrary to Scripture
- Serves biblical purposes
- Reflects biblical values

2. EDIFYING:

- Teaches the faith
- Strengthens believers
- Draws people to God

3. ORDERLY:

- Creates structure
- Prevents confusion
- Provides consistency

4. REVERENT:

- Shows appropriate awe
- Distinguishes sacred from common
- Honors God's majesty

5. BEAUTIFUL:

- Reflects God's glory
- Engages all senses
- Offers our best to God

6. UNIFYING:

- Brings congregation together
- Creates common identity
- Builds community

HOOKER'S BALANCED WORSHIP INCLUDES:

WORD:

- Scripture reading
- Preaching
- Teaching

PRAYER:

- Corporate prayers
- Personal prayers
- Both set and spontaneous

SACRAMENTS:

- Baptism and Communion
- Celebrated reverently
- Properly understood

MUSIC:

- Psalms and hymns
- Congregational singing
- Beautiful music

CEREMONY:

- Reverent gestures
- Appropriate vestments
- Ordered liturgy

BEAUTY:

- Excellence in all things
- Visual aids to worship
- Honorable settings

ALL IN SERVICE OF:

- Glorifying God
- Teaching truth
- Building up believers
- Proclaiming the gospel

HISTORICAL CONTEXT: The Worship Wars of the 1590s

What the Puritans Wanted to Remove

FROM CHURCH BUILDINGS:

- Altars (wanted tables)
- Stained glass (wanted plain)
- Organs (wanted only voices)
- Vestments (wanted plain clothes)
- Candles (except for light)
- Crosses (even on buildings)

FROM WORSHIP SERVICES:

- Book of Common Prayer (wanted free prayer)
- Kneeling at communion (wanted sitting/standing)
- Set prayers (wanted spontaneous only)

- Responses (wanted preaching only)
- Sign of cross in baptism (wanted simple water)

FROM CHURCH CALENDAR:

- Christmas (not in Scripture)
- Easter (date calculation "Popish")
- Saints' days (all of them)
- Church seasons (Advent, Lent, etc.)

What Anglicans Defended

Their claim: These practices

- Have ancient precedent
- Serve edification
- Don't contradict Scripture
- Aid reverence and order
- Teach the faith effectively

NOT claimed:

- These are absolutely required
- These earn salvation
- These are divinely mandated
- Rome's version is right

The Stakes

If Puritans won:

- Complete restructuring of worship
- Destruction of much church art/architecture
- Loss of 1,000+ years of Christian practice

- Uncertainty about what's allowed

If Anglicans won:

- Retained traditional beauty
- Continued ordered worship
- Kept connection with church history
- Maintained via media

Hooker's argument: Reformed doctrine CAN go with traditional worship. Don't let reaction to Rome destroy good practices.